

Nikhil Rao

CONTACT

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EMPLOYMENT	Postdoctoral Fellow , National Bureau of Economic Research	2025–2027
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Economics , University of Michigan	2025
	M.A., Economics , University of Michigan	2021
	B.A., Economics & Mathematics , University of Massachusetts Amherst	2015
FIELDS	Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics	
WORKING PAPERS	“Measuring Discrimination using Natural Experiments” , with James Reeves.	
IN PROGRESS	“Using Network Data to Measure Social Returns and Improve Targeting of Crime-Reduction Interventions” , with Ashley Craig and Sara Heller. “Examining Interventions to Improve Outcomes of Justice-involved Individuals” , with James Reeves. “Peer Socioeconomic Mismatch and Student Achievement” , with Micah Y. Baum. “Parental Resources and College Major Choice” , with Zsigmond Pálvölgyi & Tyler Radler.	
PUBLICATIONS	“Inflation Expectations and Nonlinearities in the Phillips Curve” , with Alexander Doser, Ricardo Nunes and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Journal of Applied Econometrics</i> 38:4 (2023), 453–471. “Sectoral inflation and the Phillips curve: What has changed since the Great Recession?” , with Maria Jose Luengo-Prado and Viacheslav Sheremirov. <i>Economics Letters</i> 172 (2018), 63–68.	
EXTERNAL PRESENTATIONS	2025 Tufts University Brownbag Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars University of Colorado 2024 Southern Economic Association Meeting Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management Fall Conference Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime Western Economic Association Conference Texas Economics of Crime Workshop 2019 Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting	Medford, MA Philadelphia, PA Denver, CO Washington, DC National Harbor, MD Zurich, Switzerland Seattle, WA Austin, TX Lansing, MI
AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	Department of Economics Fellowship Rackham One Term Dissertation Fellowship Rackham Conference Travel Grant Department of Economics Conference Travel Grant Poverty Solutions One Term Fellowship	2025 2024 2024 (x2) 2019; 2024 (x2) 2023

	Department of Economics Research Grant	2022; 2023
	Sasakawa Young Leaders Fellowship	2018–2019
TEACHING	University of Michigan Economics of the Population (ECON 466) Introductory Macroeconomics (ECON 102) Introductory Microeconomics (ECON 101)	Fall 2020 Winter 2020 Fall 2019
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE & EMPLOYMENT	University of Michigan Graduate Research Assistant to Ashley Craig & Sara Heller Summer Research Assistant to Ana Reynoso Summer Research Assistant to Lauren Falcao Bergquist Federal Reserve Bank of Boston Senior Research Assistant, Jenny Tang & Viacheslav Sheremirov	2020–2024 2020 2019 2015–2018
SERVICE	Referee: <i>American Law and Economics Review</i> , <i>Journal of Human Resources</i> Graduate Program Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society Admissions Committee, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society Social Chair, University of Michigan Graduate Economics Society	2021–2022 2020–2021 2019–2020
OTHER	Analytics and Programming: Stata, R, Matlab and L ^A T _E X Clearance: U.S. Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status Citizenship: USA	
REFERENCES	Sara Heller Associate Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan sbheller@umich.edu	Basit Zafar Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan bzafar@umich.edu
	Michael Mueller-Smith Associate Professor Department of Economics University of Michigan mgms@umich.edu	Ashley Craig Senior Lecturer Research School of Economics Australian National University ashley.craig@anu.edu.au